

PURPOSE: To clearly define what activities count towards wellness requirements at MSMS.

INTRODUCED BY: Morgan Smith

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE MISSISSIPPI SCHOOL FOR MATHEMATICS AND SCIENCE

SECTION ONE (DEFINITIONS):

Wellness: A system by which MSMS grades students on their ability to fulfill a combination of activities which contribute to their mental and physical health.

SECTION TWO (REASONING):

Currently, the handbook does not provide a list of activities approved for wellness. Instead, it simply states that wellness requirements are to be explained during orientation. By explicitly stating what activities will be counted as wellness in the handbook, we can cut out any confusion that may arise from students missing orientation, misremembering details or getting their information from unreliable sources (their friends.) Additionally, it would become much easier for the Senate to amend the list of approved wellness activities if they were included in the handbook.

I have spoken to Miss Kei Lei, who is in support of this change. Clearing up any confusion around wellness would only make her job as MSMS's Wellness Supervisor easier. The newly revised handbook would include information from a graphic she sent out earlier this year:

MSMS WELLNESS REQUIREMENTS

The Mississippi School for Mathematics and Science requires all students meet wellness requirements for graduation, which includes a combination of physical activity and wellness seminar participation. Requirements are as follows.

GRADING & CRITERIA

TO RECEIVE AN "A" (Highest possible grade):
Student must acquire 15+ wellness hours and attend at least 2 wellness seminars.

TO RECEIVE AN "A-"
Students must acquire 14-15 wellness hours and attend 2 wellness seminars. OR student must acquire 15+ wellness hours and attend 1 wellness seminar.

WHAT IF I DO NOT MEET THE CRITERIA?
If students do not meet the required wellness hours (at least 14) or required seminar attendance (2 or more), it will result in a failing grade of a "U".

EXTRA

But wait! YOU CAN EARN EXTRA CREDIT...

Any extra seminars (more than the 2 required) may count towards extra wellness hours. 1 hour will be awarded for every 1 extra seminar attended.

Also, students who earn an "A" for the current nine weeks will be awarded 2 wellness hours towards the following nine weeks. (Example: Student earned an "A" in Wellness for the 2nd nine weeks, they now have 2 hours added to their total for the 3rd nine weeks.)

THIS IS WELLNESS

YES

- PARTICIPATION in MSMS sponsored sports and clubs (Swim, Cross Country, Soccer, Tennis, Volleyball, Bk Diamond/Water Polo)
- Classes in Stark Recreation Center (Yoga, Pilates, POUND, Kickboxing, etc.)
- Frisbee
- Basketball
- Riding bicycles or scooters
- Skating
- Swimming
- Walking (downstairs, Riverwalk, Public Library, around campus)
- MSMS sponsored events and trips (dances, bowling, etc., Skate Zone, Field Day, Tail Tag)
- Special events held in Columbus (Dixieville Fest, Market Street Festival, Trunk or Treat, etc.)
- Talent (Mr. Yarbrough's class)
- Creative Movement Class
- Activities and classes approved by wellness coordinator

THIS IS NOT WELLNESS

NO NO NO

- Activities done while at home
- Activities done in students' rooms
- Any classes or activities taken outside of MSMS/Stark Recreation Center without prior approval
- Reading outside
- studying outside
- Drawing or painting outside
- Sitting outside

IMPORTANT NOTES

- Events and activities **MUST BE LOGGED** on orange cards to receive credit
- Wellness seminars will be rotated throughout the semester for Seniors, staff and students. Seniors **MUST SIGN IN** to receive credit for seminar attendance
- Allowing sign-out cards are for 10th and 11th graders if going to specific locations (downstairs Public Library, etc.) and 12th graders (walking around campus)
- Failure to sign-in on date signed will result in student's sign-out time to be marked through and not counted.
- Allowing sign-out cards are for 10th and 11th graders if going to specific locations (downstairs Public Library, etc.) and 12th graders (walking around campus)

IMPORTANT DATES

1ST 9 WEEKS:
ENDS OCT. 8TH
CARDS PICKED UP OCT. 8TH @ 10 PM

2ND 9 WEEKS:
ENDS DEC. 10TH
CARDS PICKED UP DEC. 10TH @ 10 PM

3RD 9 WEEKS:
ENDS FEB. 10TH
CARDS PICKED UP FEB. 10TH @ 10 PM

4TH 9 WEEKS:
ENDS MAY 10TH
CARDS PICKED UP MAY 10TH @ 10 PM

SECTION THREE (SPECIFIC CHANGE):

On page 53 of the student handbook (PDF) under ACADEMIC PROGRAM and MSMS NON-ACADEMIC REQUIREMENTS FOR GRADUATION, the following would be changed:

Wellness

The MSMS Wellness Program requires each student to participate in a minimum number of physical activity hours and minimum attendance in wellness seminars ~~as directed by the coordinator for this program and explained during orientation~~. Students can earn wellness hours by participating in activities including:

- Participation in MSMS sponsored sports and clubs (Swim, Cross Country, Soccer, Tennis, Volleyball, Blu Diamondz/Blue Knights)
- Classes in Stark Recreation Center (Yoga, Pilates, POUND, Kickboxing etc.)
- Frisbee
- Basketball
- Riding bicycles or scooters
- Skating
- Swinging
- Walking (downtown, Riverwalk, Public Library, around campus)
- MSMS sponsored events and trips (dances, bowling trips, Skate Zone, Field Day, Taki Tiki, etc.)
- Special events held in Columbus (Wassail Fest, Market Street Festival, Trunk or Treat, etc.)
- Tales from the Crypt (~~Mr. Yarborough's class~~)
- Creative Movement Class
- Activities and classes approved by wellness coordinator

The following activities may not count towards a student's wellness hours:

- Activities done while at home
- Activities done in students' rooms
- Any classes or activities taken outside of MSMS/Stark Recreation Center without prior approval
- Reading outside
- Studying outside
- Drawing or painting outside
- Sitting outside

Wellness grading criteria consist of the following:

- To receive an "O" (Outstanding): Student must acquire 15+ wellness hours and attend at least 2 wellness seminars.
- To receive an "S": Students must acquire 14-15 wellness hours and attend 2 wellness seminars OR student must acquire 15+ wellness hours and attend one wellness seminar.
- If students do not meet the required wellness hours (at least 14) or required seminar attendance (two or more), it will result in an Unsatisfactory grade of a "U".
- Any extra seminars (more than the two required) may count towards extra wellness hours. One hour will be awarded for every one extra seminar attended.
- Students who earn an "O" for the current nine weeks will be awarded two wellness hours towards the following nine weeks.

Additionally, on page 106 under STUDENT AFFAIRS – RESIDENCE LIFE and WELLNESS, the following would be changed:

The links among nutrition, physical activity, and learning are well-documented. MSMS is committed to providing a school environment that enhances learning and the development of lifelong wellness practices. To ensure that all MSMS students have the opportunity to develop the knowledge and skills necessary to make nutritious food choices and enjoyable physical activity a valuable part of daily life, they are required to participate in a wellness component as a requirement for graduation. The wellness program requirements include a combination of wellness seminars and physical activity. Wellness grades will have an impact on eligibility for privilege plans, and failure to maintain a satisfactory "S" grade in wellness will be a consideration when extending invitations to return. ~~Details regarding the wellness component will be provided during class orientations.~~